File organization

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- Think about **folders**, **data stages**, **naming**, and **README** habits before deeper tooling in later modules.

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- Start **simple**; let the tree grow when the project grows.
  - Resist the temptation to over-engineer too early.

> *Premature optimization is the root of all evil (or at least most of it) in programming.*
> *— Knuth*

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- Assume work will be **shared** and **reproduced**, even when you work alone: you are the future reader.

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- Newcomers should find **inputs**, **code**, and **outputs** without a scavenger hunt.
- Clear structure speeds **collaboration** and **trust** in how the analysis was done.

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- Early conventions pay off when you reopen the repo months later.

Terminology

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- **File structure**, **hierarchy**, and **schema** are used interchangeably for how directories nest.

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- Balance setup time with time spent actually analyzing.
- Don't worship rules over clarity.

> *A foolish consistency is the hobgoblin of little minds. — Emerson*

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2. Treat analysis like an **assembly line**: raw $\rightarrow$ cleaned $\rightarrow$ analyzed $\rightarrow$ reported; each stage has a clear home.
3. Separate **scratch** from **finished** code; when a script's job is done, **rename** it usefully and **start a new file** for the next experiment. Don't recycle the same filename for unrelated work.

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5. **Internal consistency** beats copying someone else's tree blindly.

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- **CARE** (especially with human/community data): **Collective benefit**, **Authority to control**, **Responsibility**, **Ethics**.
- **Reproducibility heuristics** (practical lab version): deterministic scripts, pinned environments, and one-command rebuilds.

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- Folders group **similar roles**: e.g. preprocessing vs model-based analyses.

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- **Final analysis inputs**: the dataset your main pipeline actually reads. That separates "latest guess" from trusted inputs and avoids `_final_final` filename chaos.

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Include	Sometimes include
Date	Data source / operator
How the run was done	Whether this is a repeat, re-parameterization, or new method
Notes on outputs	

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- Prefer **scripts** over one-off CLI-only steps so results are **repeatable**.
- **"Data to table"**: automate raw $\rightarrow$ cleaned $\rightarrow$ tables/figures so tweaks are reruns, not archaeology.

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- **Makefiles** or similar help larger projects record **build order** and dependencies.

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4. A **README** (`README.md`) with purpose, setup, and conventions.
5. Places for **outputs** and **docs** (e.g. `output/`, `docs/`) once the project earns them.

```
projectName/
  data/
    raw/
    deidentified/
    processed/
  docs/
    index.md
  output/
  src/
    main.py
    utils.py
    preprocessing/
    modelBasedAnalysis/
  README.md
```

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3. Let **distinguishing parameters** (time, subject, instrument, condition) show up in paths and names.
4. Prefer the **simplest** tree you can **inspect and debug**; don't front-load complexity.

Case studies (MIT CommKit)

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- **Large / multi-paper:** Case study 3 (complex hierarchy)

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2. **Short**; use a **README** for abbreviations.
3. Let **parent folders** carry context so filenames stay lean.

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- Dates in filenames: `YYYY_MM_DD` so sorts are chronological (`2024_07_01`).

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- Dates in filenames: `YYYY_MM_DD` so sorts are chronological (`2024_07_01`).
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- Match **team conventions** when you join a lab.

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- The full path (folders + file) tells humans **which idea** each segment carries.
- Folders usually name **one** idea; filenames may combine several.

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  - Ideas: experiment (+ version) · participant ID · acquisition date.
- Mostly you want to manage the number of files in a folder with a simple hierarchy.

Ordering ideas in paths

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- **Version** tokens (`_v1`, `_v2`) come **last** so they don't obscure the main identity.
- Chaotic version suffixes undermine confidence in the work.

Delimiters: `snake_case` and `camelCase`

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- Separate word groups so ideas don't blur: **`process_data.py`**, **`processedData.csv`**.
- **camelCase**: capitalize **subsequent** words only (`firstName`, `rdmData`).
- Mixing styles within one name can work if the pattern stays **readable** (examples from the MIT notes: `20190701.GeorgeSun.v1.csv` vs `20190701_davidLarson_v1.csv`).

No spaces in project paths

- Spaces in repo paths break **shell** and **tooling** workflows; use –, _, or case switches instead.

Further reading

- MIT CommKit: File structure

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- Russell A. Poldrack, Better Code, Better Science: Project organization